

★ = high chance of appearing (ranked against past IBPS PO Mains papers and 2026 bank exams). Each answer is followed by the key fact and its source. Marking: +1.2 right, -0.30 wrong.

1. At the post-policy press conference on 5 August 2026, RBI Governor Sanjay Malhotra said India expects to introduce polymer (plastic) banknotes, subject to field trials, from: ★

Ans (A) The beginning of FY 2027-28

Malhotra said polymer ₹10 and ₹20 notes could enter circulation from early FY28 (around April 2027) if the pilot succeeds (RBI briefing, 5 Aug 2026; Business Standard/Business Today).

2. In August 2026, the Central Government appointed which former ISRO Chairman as a part-time non-official director on the Central Board of the Reserve Bank of India for four years?

Ans (D) S. Somanath

Ex-ISRO chief S. Somanath was appointed to the RBI Central Board and Anand Mahindra was reappointed for another four-year term (Moneycontrol/Business Standard, 20-21 Aug 2026).

3. RBI's list of NBFCs in the Upper Layer (NBFC-UL) for 2026-27, released in August 2026, contains how many NBFCs? ★

Ans (A) 17

The RBI expanded the Upper-Layer NBFC list to 17 for FY27, adding REC, PFC, IRFC and HUDCO and keeping Tata Sons on it (The Statesman, 6 Aug 2026; Adda247, 7 Aug 2026).

4. Under RBI's draft framework (August 2026) for on-tap licensing of new Urban Co-operative Banks, a credit co-operative society seeking conversion into a UCB must have a minimum deposit base of: ★

Ans (A) ₹10,000 crore

The draft on-tap UCB licensing norms, which end a 22-year freeze on new licences, require deposits of ₹10,000 crore and net worth of ₹300 crore (RBI draft, 5 Aug 2026; Business Standard/ET BFSI).

5. 'PosTransfer', a UPI-powered cross-border remittance service to India launched in August 2026 in partnership with India Post and the Universal Postal Union (UPU), was introduced by the postal service of which country?

Ans (C) Qatar

Qatar Post launched PosTransfer so Indians in Qatar can send money home to UPI IDs, in partnership with India Post and the UPU (The Peninsula, 15 Aug 2026; DD India/Firstpost, 17 Aug 2026).

6. The Bankers' Books Evidence Bill, 2026, passed by Parliament in August 2026 to give legal recognition to electronic and digital banking records, replaces the Bankers' Books Evidence Act of which year? ★

Ans (C) 1891

Parliament passed the Bill (Rajya Sabha, 10 Aug 2026), replacing the 135-year-old Bankers' Books Evidence Act, 1891 (The Hindu/Livemint/DD India, 10 Aug 2026).

7. As per NSO data released on 31 August 2026, India's real GDP growth for Q1 (April-June) of FY 2026-27 was: ★

Ans (B) 7.8%

The NSO's first estimate put Q1 FY27 real GDP growth at 7.8% on the new 2022-23 base series (NSO/MoSPI, 31 Aug 2026; The Statesman/BW Businessworld).

8. India's all-India CPI (combined) inflation for July 2026, released by MoSPI on 12 August 2026 under the new series (base 2024=100), stood at:

Ans (D) 4.45%

Retail inflation rose to 4.45% in July 2026 from 4.38% in June; food inflation was 5.52% (MoSPI CPI release, 12 Aug 2026; ETV Bharat/Financial Express).

9. In August 2026, the Government launched an Offer for Sale (OFS) of up to 6.5% stake in Life Insurance Corporation of India (LIC). What was the floor price per share?

Ans (B) ₹382

The Government's LIC OFS for up to 6.5% (including green shoe) opened on 4 Aug 2026 (retail 5 Aug) at a floor price of ₹382 per share (Upstox/CNBC TV18, 4 Aug 2026).

10. Who took charge as the Chief Executive Officer of NITI Aayog in August 2026, succeeding B.V.R. Subrahmanyam?

Ans (A) Anurag Jain

Anurag Jain (IAS 1989, MP cadre, ex-MP Chief Secretary) was appointed for two years on 22 Jul 2026 and took charge on 17 Aug 2026 (DD India/Livemint, 17 Aug 2026; Business Standard, 18 Aug 2026).

11. Kerala was officially renamed 'Keralam' in August 2026 after Parliament passed a law to that effect. Under which Article of the Constitution does Parliament have the power to alter the name of a State? ★

Ans (A) Article 3

Article 3 lets Parliament alter a State's name; the Centre notified 'Keralam' as Kerala's official name on 25 Aug 2026 (The Hindu/Times of India, 25 Aug 2026).

12. Which country won the FIH Men's Hockey World Cup 2026, defeating Spain 1-0 in the final in August 2026?

Ans (A) Germany

Germany beat Spain 1-0 with Michel Struthoff's 44th-minute goal to retain the title, their fourth, equalling Pakistan's record; Argentina won the women's title over the Netherlands on a shootout (FIH/Olympics.com, 30 Aug 2026).

13. In August 2026, which Indian Grandmaster became the first Indian to win the Grand Chess Tour by defeating Fabiano Caruana 15-13 in the GCT Finals?

Ans (D) R. Praggnanandhaa

R. Praggnanandhaa came back from a 0-6 deficit to beat Caruana 15-13 and become the first Indian GCT champion (FIDE/The Hindu/Chess.com, 28 Aug 2026).

14. The 15th edition of Exercise MAITREE (MAITREE-XV), which began on 18 August 2026, is a joint military exercise between India and:

Ans (C) Thailand

MAITREE-XV is the India-Thailand army exercise; an 85-member Indian contingent left on 17 Aug 2026 for counter-terrorism training in jungle and semi-urban terrain (PIB/ThePrint, 17 Aug 2026).

15. The 17th Conference of the Parties (COP17) to the UN Convention to Combat Desertification (UNCCD) was held from 17 to 28 August 2026 in:

Ans (C) Ulaanbaatar, Mongolia

UNCCD COP17 met in Ulaanbaatar from 17 to 28 Aug 2026 ('Restoring Land, Restoring Hope'), with Bhupender Yadav representing India; COP16 was held in Riyadh (UNCCD/PIB, Aug 2026).